Math materials and activities

7.1 Staff relate math/activities to current topic of interest (Ex: make chart on what children ate for breakfast; insect counting game added when talking about insects; big/small leaf game offered when talking about autumn)

Observe once

13. Encouraging children to use language

Staff help children communicate verbally with one another (e.g., using polite language, initiating conversations).

Observe twice

Math materials and activities

7.2 Staff ask children questions about math materials/activities that stimulate reasoning (Ex. “What do you think would happen if we put all the feathers on one side of the scale and a block on the other side?” “What will happen to the square shape if we add another square block?”)

Observe once

13. Encouraging children to use language

Staff ask many questions that require longer answers (e.g., questions begin with "how," "what if," "why").

Observe twice

Math materials and activities

7.3 Some appropriate math activities requiring more teacher input are used (Ex. Sort seashells on a chart and compare more or less; read thermometer to chart daily temperature; measure while doing a cooking activity)

Observe once

13. Encouraging children to use language

Staff conversations go beyond classroom activities to include social talk about home, family life, and community activities.

Observe once

Math in daily events

3.1 Staff occasionally count or use math words during transitions or routines (Ex: count while children wash hands; tell amount of time until clean-up; use “first”, “second”, “third” when giving directions)

Observe once

14. Staff use books with children

Appropriate books related to current classroom activities or themes are read to or used with children.

Observe once

Math in daily events

3.2 Staff sometimes use math talk as children play with non-math materials in non math areas (Ex: count blocks in a child's tower; match blocks to size and shape labels during clean-up; ask how many pieces of toy pizza fit into the pizza pan; mention numbers of colors used in a child's painting while pointing them out)

Observe once

14. Staff use books with children

Staff and children discuss the content of a book in a way that engages children.

Observe once

Math in daily events

3.3 Staff use math talk referring to daily events during large group time (Ex: counting who is present and absent; reminding children how many days are left before the weekend)

Observe once

14. Staff use books with children

Staff use books informally with children with more than one example observed.

Observe twice

Math in daily events

5.1 Staff encourage math learning as part of daily routines (Ex: explain setting table; name rectangular and round tables when saying where to put plates and cups; counting to 20 while washing hands; using measuring cups to serve portions at meals).

Observe twice

14. Staff use books with children

Staff use books with children to help answer questions and to help provide information on things that children are curious about.

Observe once

Math in daily events

5.2 Staff engage children in conversations about math as they play in non-math areas (Ex: discuss using a measuring cup to water plant; count how many teacups are needed for the dolls; talk about how to measure feet in a play shoe store)

Observe twice

Math in daily events

7.1 Staff help children connect printed numbers or shapes with everyday use in their environment (Ex: count number of days on the calendar until fieldtrip; talk about the numbers on the clock and what they mean in terms of going outside to play; talk about shapes of traffic signs while in blocks)

Observe once

16. Becoming familiar with print

Staff point out and read print to children (e.g., read names on displayed pictures, points to words in books).

Observe once

Math in daily events

7.2 Staff often use questions while interacting with children in non-math areas to encourage children to explain their own math reasoning (Ex: “How do you know that one more person can play here”;

Observe once

16. Becoming familiar with print

Staff observed writing down what a child says in a way that engages the child.

(This must be observed. Displayed evidence does not count)

Observed twice

Math in daily events

7.3 Children age 4 and older given more complex math-related tasks (Ex: count number of children in a group to figure out how many are not present; count children to figure out the number of milk cartons needed for lunch; use a tape measure to see if a table will fit in a space; use a map while talking about a field trip, noting number of blocks or miles traveled)

Observe once

16. Becoming familiar with print

Picture/word instructions are used to guide children through multi-step activities (Ex: cooking recipe; planting seeds instruction; handwashing)

Observe once

Understanding written numbers

3.3 When children play with toy phones, numbers on play kitchen, play money or number stencils in writing center point out the numbers and talk about them in a way that interests' children.

Observe once

Learning Activities - 17. Fine Motor

Staff show more extended interest in what children create/do with materials (Ex: have conversations about what they make; show how to use materials; have children select materials of appropriate interest and difficulty)

Observe two different children

Understanding written numbers

3.4 Staff sometimes relate print numbers to corresponding number of pictures or objects (Ex: Staff points to numbers on puzzle or in a counting book and helps child count the number of pictures that match)

Observe once

Learning Activities - 17. Fine Motor

Staff use their comments and questions to help children expand their use of exact words, understand relevant concepts, or associate spoken language with written language (Ex: watch and talk about what makes the gears move or how the blocks interlock; discuss the picture the puzzle makes; print what the child said on his drawing or on a photo of her construction)

Observe once

Understanding written numbers

5.3 Staff show children how to use materials and talk about the meaning of printed numbers (Ex: count objects with child and read the number; use "First, second, third" as child uses printed number sequence; points out numbers on ruler or thermometer, showing how they indicate differences in size and amount)

Observe once

18. Art

3.3 Some positive staff involvement with children using art materials (Ex: staff make comments to show appreciation about a child's work; identify colors or shapes seen in a child's creation)

Observe once

Understanding written numbers

7.3 Staff frequently show children how to use the number materials and talk about the meaning o printed numbers

Observe twice

18. Art

Staff have conversations with interested children about their work (Ex: " Tell me about your picture"; "How did you make that clay form?")

Observed twice

Understanding written numbers

7.4 Print numbers are sometimes related to number of fingers shown by staff or children (Ex. When reading number book or looking at number poster; when using toys showing numbers)

Observe once

Music and movement

Staff point out rhyming words in songs, identify sound repetition such as consonants or vowels, or do finger plays where children use gestures or actions to act out the meaning of the words.

Observe once

Promoting acceptance of diversity

7.1 Inclusion of diversity is observed as a part of learning activities (Ex. Sing songs in more than one language; play music from varying cultures; use sign language for some words)

Observe once

Music and movement

Staff encourage older preschoolers to experiment with rhyming in songs, thinking of new words that rhyme (Ex: model the practice and then help children to think of another word)

Observe once

Promoting acceptance of diversity

7.2 Staff have positive conversations with children discussing the benefits of similarities nd differences among people

Observe once

20. Blocks

Staff point out the math concepts that are demonstrated in unit blocks in a way that interests children (Ex: discuss more or less; relationships in size or shape; "Look, these two squares make a rectangle, just like this one"; number of blocks; measurement)

Observe once

Discipline

5.2 Staff explain reasons for why they cannot permit specific behaviors (Ex: “Please get down, I’m afraid you will fall and get hurt.” “Hitting hurts. We can’t hit in our class.”

Observe once

5. Child Related Display

Staff talk about display materials (e.g., handwashing display, classroom jobs, weather chart).

Observed twice

15. Encouraging children's use of books

Children show interest in accessible books (e.g., choosing to use books in the cozy area during free play).

Observe once

Dramatic Play

Staff carry on conversations with the children as they play., joining in but not taking over (Ex: relate children's play to their home experiences; discuss the roles children are playing; encourage paly based on field trip

Observed twice

22. Nature/science

3.2 Staff talk about nature/science with the children during the observation (Ex: do a weather chart; ask names of animals in pictures; talk about healthful foods at lunch)

Observe once

4. Space for privacy

Staff interact positively with children who play alone or with a friend to discuss ideas.

Observe twice

22. Nature/science

5.2 Staff use and talk about nature/science materials with children

Observe once

22. Nature/science

5.3 Staff model concern for the environment (Ex: remind children to turn off light to save resources; recycle; discuss how insects can be helpful)

Observe once

5. Child Related Display

Staff use display to encourage informal conversations with children.

Observe once

22. Nature/science

7.2 one or more pets/plants present that children can easily observe, help with care for, and that are talked about with the children (Ex: classroom fish tank, hamster, gerbil; birds that are seen visiting filled bird feeder).

Observe once

5. Child Related Display

Staff are observed pointing out and reading words in the display in a way that interests children.

Observe once

Math materials and activities

3.2 Staff sometimes get information or ask basic questions about math as children play with the materials (Ex: name puzzle shapes, count number of beads in a pattern; talk about “BIG” and “little”; ask “how many” or “what shape”?)

Observe once

Literacy & Language - 12. Helping children expand vocabulary

Staff explain unfamiliar words in a way children can understand (e.g., "When I say I am concerned, I mean that I care what happens to you").

Observe twice

Math materials and activities

5.2 Staff frequently join in children's play with math materials (Ex: ask questions; respond to children's questions; show enthusiasm; teach children to use materials)

Observe 3 examples

Literacy & Language - 12. Helping children expand vocabulary

Staff add information and ideas to expand children's understanding of words they use.

Observe twice